

An already great brand, amplified.

The brief is not asking for a rebrand. The work is to tighten, focus, make consistent and consolidate. Below are my first thoughts on where Renegade goes next.

What renegade means, and what it should mean here

A renegade is a person who behaves in a rebelliously unconventional manner. But Renegade doesn't want to be punk, and doesn't want to be confrontational. It wants to be progressive.

Renegade makes new wines. It experiments and pushes boundaries. And because it doesn't have a vineyard, it doesn't need to lean on the same old wine imagery that plagues most other winemakers - rolling hills, fields of vines, open space.

It is an urban winery in a major hub of people, sourcing its grapes from other producers and working with them to bring in quality fruit from all over. It does this while maintaining a focus on diversity and inclusivity, championing the people who make the wine and the people who enjoy it.



The eyes are the asset

One of the key assets of the brand is the eyes that make up the labels. Every wine carries a unique human name and a photograph of human eyes filling the entire label.

This is very unusual for winemaking - an incredible defiance of tradition that, at the same time, champions people and community. It should be retained, and expanded upon.



One voice, not two

Elsewhere within the brand, the communication holds conflicting tones of voice. In headlines and straplines, Renegade pushes the rule-breaker narrative - fearless, burn the rule book, breaking the rules. But elsewhere it speaks in an informative, educational manner, explaining processes and beginnings, and even describes that London doesn't have wine heritage, so there are no rules to break. That contradicts the headlines.

The opportunity is to lean into one narrative and allow it to underpin all communications. My suggestion is to focus more on the welcoming, educational aspect of the brand and to step away from rule-breaking, for two reasons: to meet the request of the brief and angle away from being confrontational and punk, and because a key regional competitor, Vagabond Wines, already runs its own tagline of wine without the rules.

I am not suggesting removing the angle of being free from the restraint of rules altogether. I think it can instead be framed as **redefining heritage rather than breaking rules**. Not flying in the face of history, but stepping forward and pioneering.

The gaze

With a stronger focus on Renegade welcoming us into the future of urban winemaking, this links neatly into the community strategy - and goes hand in hand with those eyes that follow you round the room from every bottle.

The shelves of any wine merchant are made more interesting by a selection of bottles that watch you consider them, see you pick them up, and look up at you as you buy them. Impossible to ignore, touching on the instinct of humans to return the gaze of a pair of eyes. The same feeling you get when you are alone in a portrait gallery and feel like you are being watched. It evokes something: a primal instinct to respond, by looking back, and engaging.

The bottles are not dissimilar from such works of art. And beyond that, their messaging highlights and celebrates the diversity of the wines themselves, and of the people who make and drink them. I think this could be expanded on.



Where the portraits could go

The bottle shows only the eyes. But what is happening around them?

Beyond the crop. Perhaps the full image reveals a scene you could never have assumed from looking into a pair of eyes on a bottle.

In the venues. The full images hanging as artwork across both sites.

On the website. Portraits in ornate frames pictured beside the wines themselves, with the eyes following the cursor around the page (inspired by sites such as [Creative Boom](#)).

Beyond photography. Perhaps some bottles are not photographs but paintings, collaborating with artists in the community.

The eyes are one of the core personalities of the brand, and could be used far more consistently throughout the messaging to confirm how inclusive, different and unique Renegade truly is. It is a wonderful part of the story and should be heroed more - particularly when you remember that Renegade is an urban winery, located in one of the biggest melting pots of people in the entire world. No need to think about vines, fields, the countryside. Urban people are the key thing here.

Moodboard





Reference imagery, collected for direction only. All images remain the property of their respective creators.



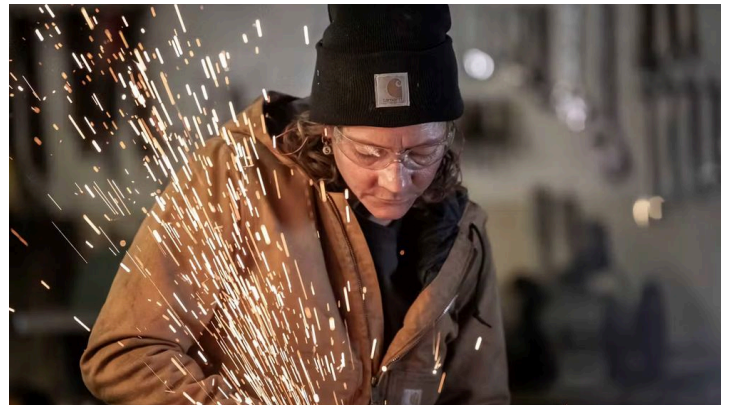
An example of labels where the eyes are still the feature, but as seen above, the wider image takes on a whole new meaning.

Three references



Monzo

Monzo walked into perhaps the most tradition-bound industry in Britain, and seemingly flipped it upside down. They utilise a great tone of voice, talking directly to their consumer with inclusive, explanatory language. In the world of finance, where it can so often feel confusing and complicated with lots of numbers and legal terms, Monzo subverted expectations and became friends with their consumer, without losing their position as a challenger bank doing things differently.

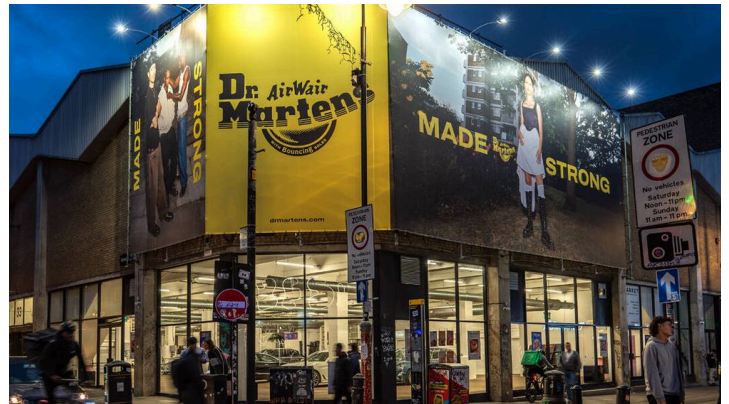


Carhartt

Carhartt do an amazing job of putting the people who do the work at the centre, and meaning it structurally. When they advertise, the models in its campaigns are mostly real tradespeople - carpenters, fishermen, glass blowers, farmers - found through a network its creative team built rather than cast through an agency. This community based approach is extremely likeable.

When a campaign made a diverse cast genuinely hard to assemble, the team worked harder rather than settling, and platformed Bertony Faustin, Oregon's first Black winemaker. This feels Renegade to me.

LBB, 2021



Dr Martens

Dr. Martens is another great example of using genuine customers as their brand ambassadors and within their campaigns and advertising. They also do it with a rebellious air to their brand - a great combination.

One question I had

The site says around half the fruit comes from France, Spain, Germany, Italy and Portugal, and that not every Renegade wine can be called English. The brief says premium English vineyards.

I am curious which direction Renegade intend to travel in? It will slightly change how to position the branding, depending on whether Renegade is solely producing English wines or whether some of the grapes are also European.

Who I am

Tristan Gage, creative based in E17.

I used to live in E1 and have enjoyed your wines at the arch. I now live in E17 and I had my engagement party at the Walthamstow winery last year during harvest — we were handed grapes off the press while they were being processed behind us. I couldn't make the immersion evening in August, but I've spent time in both rooms as a customer and had wonderful times.

I am also an early-career creative who has spent the last year working his way into the advertising industry. An alumni of D&AD's prestigious Shift 2025 programme, I recently interned at Bloom Design in Clapham and am continuing to dig deeper on brand and creative advertising.

I would love an opportunity to get involved on this project and develop ideas further (and explore new ones) and so welcome any feedback after review of my submission. Thank you so much for your time.

Portfolio: tristangage.co.uk